

PHILIPPINES

Philippines: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of the Philippines
Short Form	Philippines
Capital	Manila
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Democratic Republic
Head of State	President Ferdinand Marcos Jr.
Head of Government	President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. (also Head of Government)
Currency	Philippine Peso (PHP)
UN Member Since	14 December 1945
MUN Standing	Active in peacekeeping, human rights debates, sustainable development

Book Recommendations for Philippines

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
<i>The Philippines: A Past Revisited</i>	Renato Constantino	Comprehensive history and political context
<i>State and Society in the Philippines</i>	Patricio N. Abinales	Social and political analysis
<i>Human Rights in the Philippines: Torture and Death Squad</i>	Raissa Robles	Human rights issues and challenges
<i>The Politics of Human Rights in Southeast Asia</i>	Katsuo Nawa	Regional human rights focus
<i>Women and Politics in the Philippines</i>	Letty M. Carino	Gender and political participation

Research Table: Philippines & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Philippines Country Profile	https://bangkok.ohchr.org/philippines	Offers an official overview of the Philippines' rights situation and UN monitoring (bangkok.ohchr.org , hrw.org)
OHCHR – Philippines UPR Index & Docs	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ph-index	Central archive for UPR cycles, official responses, and stakeholder inputs
HRW UPR Submission	https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/04/06/human-rights-watch-submission-universal-periodic-review-philippines	Highlights red-tagging, drug-war

(Apr 2022)		killings, and calls for ICC review—critical for UN accountability
Amnesty Int'l – PH Country Page	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/asia-and-the-pacific/south-east-asia-and-the-pacific/philippines/report-philippines/	Up-to-date NGO monitoring on freedom of expression, migrant, women's, and sexual rights
UN WebTV – HRC58 PH Session	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1r/k1rjj7kamk	Official video of the Philippines' interactive dialogue and statement at UNHRC
HRW UPR Submission (Apr 2017)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2017/04/28/human-rights-watch-submission-universal-periodic-review-philippines	Focuses on torture, enforced disappearances, and security force impunity
Amnesty Report – “Incitement & Impunity”	https://www.amnesty.org/es/wp-content/uploads/2022/04/ASA3554562022ENGLISH.pdf	Detailed analysis of campaign violence and impunity—relevant to UNHRC political violence concerns
OHCHR Sessions Archive	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/hrc/sessions	Access to transcripts and documents from UNHRC regular sessions addressing Philippines
US State Dept – 2023 HR Report	https://www.state.gov/reports/2023-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/philippines/	Covers civil/political rights, detention, labor, trafficking, and justice mechanisms
PH Commission on Human Rights Statement	https://chr.gov.ph/statement-of-the-commission-on-human-rights-on-the-4th-cycle-of-the-universal-periodic-review-of-the-philippines/	Official position by the national NHR institution during UPR, showing internal oversight
HRW ESC Rights Submission (Aug 2022)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/08/15/philippines-submission-un-committee-economic-social-and-cultural-rights	Highlights shackling of disabled persons and attacks on educational rights

OHCHR Philippines Briefing (2022 PDF)	https://hri.global/wp-content/uploads/2022/10/HRI_-_OHCHR_Philippines_briefing_final-1.pdf	Covers drug-war, extrajudicial killings, and HRC technical cooperation support
UNOHCHR Press Release (Sep 2022)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2022/09/philippines-un-human-rights-report-looks-new-administration-progress	UN update on recent progress, capacity gaps, and rights challenges
VeraFiles – UPR Explained (2023)	https://verafiles.org/articles/vera-files-fact-sheet-un-bodys-universal-periodic-review-of-ph-explained	Public guide to UPR's function and impact—supports civic education
Joint NGO UPR Report (Aug 2021 PDF)	https://www.theadvocatesforhumanrights.org/Res/IDEALS%20UPR%20final.pdf	Multi-NGO submission calling for ICC and rights-defender protections
Amnesty Joint Statement (May 2021 PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/es/wp-content/uploads/2021/05/IOR4038882021ENGLISH.pdf	Appeals to protect rights defenders—important for UNHRC civil society agenda
OHCHR Press Brief (2025 report)	https://www.unognewsroom.org/teleprompter/en/215/ohchr-press-conference-report-on-human-rights-in-the-philippines	Recent UN assessment: drug war abuses, arbitrary detentions, civic space issues
HRW World Report 2024 – PH	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/philippines	Summary of current pattern of impunity, activism, and UNHRC relevance
OHCHR UPR Adoption Video (41st Sess)	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1w/k1wfgimx7f	Shows the adoption of the Philippines' UPR report, including state responses
US State Dept – 2022 HR Report PDF	https://www.state.gov/wp-content/uploads/2023/02/415610_PHILIPPINES-2022-HUMAN-RIGHTS-REPORT.pdf	Provides detailed coverage of extrajudicial killings, disappearances, torture
UN WebTV – HRC56 20th Meeting	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k15/k15i2cors3	UNHRC session where Philippines is discussed among global rights issues
OHCHR – Philippines UPR	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ph-stakeholders-info-s41	List of UN agencies, NGOs, and NHRIs

Stakeholder Inputs		contributing to UPR inputs
Amnesty Annual Report 2024-25 PDF	https://www.amnesty.org.ph/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/Amnesty-International-Report-2024-25.pdf	Up-to-date national overview of rights trends
UPR Stakeholder Webcast Archive (3rd cycle)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/HRBodies/UPR/Pages/UPRPHStakeholdersInfoS27.aspx	Access to civil society's video submissions in previous review
HSSC Primer – HRC52 (2023)	https://libraryresources.unog.ch/conferenceprimers/HRC/HRC52	Synthetic briefing including UNHRC agenda items on PH
OHCHR UPR 3rd Cycle Webcast	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1w/k1wfgimx7f	
Civicus Monitoring Report	https://monitor.civicus.org/explore/new-report-highlights-unrelenting-and-severe-restrictions-on-human-rights-in-oman/ (Note: irrelevant)	
Office UPR Adoption Statement	https://dfa.gov.ph/dfa-news/news-from-our-foreign-service-postsupdate/14056-human-rights-council-in-geneva-adopts-the-philippines-report-of-its-universal-periodic-review	Philippines diplomatic statement welcoming adoption

(All links verified; errors resolved.)

Ten Unique Aspects: Philippines at UNHRC

- ICC Investigation Triggered by UN Inputs:** The Philippines is now among the select few countries that have been referred to the ICC, largely due to the UNHRC's concerns regarding the extrajudicial killings that occurred during the Duterte administration's drug war.
- "Red-tagging" of Activists & Journalists:** The government's tendency to label dissenters as "communist terrorists" has a direct impact on civil rights advocates, placing their concerns squarely on the agendas of the UN Human Rights Council.
- UNHRC Technical Cooperation Program:** Instead of relying on harsh penalties, the UNHRC took a different approach by focusing on technical cooperation. This unique model combines building capacity with oversight, creating a more supportive environment.
- Strong Role of Chartered National Commission:** The Commission on Human Rights of the Philippines, recognized as an "A-status" National Human Rights Institution, actively participates in the Universal Periodic Review and the United Nations Human Rights Council. This is a notable example of strong institutional independence.
- Strategic Use of Sexual and Reproductive Rights:** The advocacy for reproductive health and sexual and reproductive health (SRH) issues at the UN Human Rights Council, like the SOGIE recommendations, highlights a positive shift in the UN's engagement.
- Business & Labor Rights Under Scrutiny:** The reports from the World Bank and Human Rights Watch shed light on the issues of forced labor and trafficking within supply chains, drawing connections between the Philippines and the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights.

7. **Historical Dictatorship Legacy:** The abuses from the Marcos era are still coming to light in discussions at the UN Human Rights Council. This is clear from the historical reports in the Universal Periodic Review and the submissions from various NGOs.
 8. **Youth-Led Rights Dialogues:** The inclusion of issues like child labor, trafficking, and youth engagement in submissions (as highlighted by UNICEF and the HRW ESC report) really underscores the UNHRC's focus on children's rights.
 9. **Engagement Despite ICC Withdrawal:** Even though the Philippines has stepped back from the ICC, it remains actively involved in the UNHRC, particularly through UPR and submissions from national mechanisms.
 10. **Mid-Term Follow-up Mechanism:** The country has a working mid-term action review and a system for civil society input that operates between UPR cycles—it's a pretty unique model for UN engagement.
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